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HEADER CLUTCH SLIP DETECTION

Abstract

A vibration sensor is mounted to a corn head of an agricultural harvester. The vibration sensor generates a sensor signal indicative of sensed vibrations on the corn head. The sensor signal is converted to a digital signal and a bandpass filter is applied to filter out signals in frequency ranges that do not represent slip clutch impulses. The filtered signal is demodulated to better identify the slip impulses generated when the slip clutch is slipping. The demodulated signal is transformed to a frequency domain signal and an input frequency is calculated based upon the speed of rotation of the drive shaft (or an expected range of speeds), the slip clutch configuration, and a gear ratio of a gear box between the drive shaft and the slip clutch. The power in parts of the frequency domain signal that are within a desired range of the input frequency is compared to a threshold power value to determine whether a slip clutch is slipping. A slip status signal, indicative of whether a slip clutch is slipping, is output. A control signal is generated based upon the slip status.

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Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE DESCRIPTION

[0001] The present description relates to headers on combine harvesters. More specifically, the present description relates to detecting clutch slip on a header of a combine harvester.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Agricultural harvesters are currently in wide use. Agricultural harvesters often have a head (also referred to as a header) that is used to engage crops in a field and feed that crop into harvesting functionality within the agricultural harvester.

[0003] For example, an agricultural harvester may have a corn head that is used to engage corn crop in the field. The corn head may have a plurality of snouts or shrouds that are used to divide the corn rows and guide each row into a different row unit for processing the corn crop. Each row unit may have row unit equipment, such as gathering chains that guide the corn stalks into the row unit, snap rolls that remove the ears from the stalks, and choppers that are used to chop the corn stalks and other residue once the ears of corn are removed. The corn head also has an auger that gathers the ears of corn toward a central portion of the corn head and a conveyor that moves the crop rearward from the header into a feeder house that feeds the harvested crop back into the additional harvesting functionality that is supported by the agricultural harvester. One or more drive shafts that are often driven by a power takeoff on the agricultural harvester drive the auger and the row unit equipment through one or more different gear boxes.

[0004] During operation, the combine harvester advances through a field and the row units engage crop and begin processing that crop by severing the stalks, removing the ears from the stalks, chopping the stalks, and gathering the ears into the feeder house of the agricultural harvester, for further processing. It is not uncommon for the row unit equipment to become jammed with an excess of crop residue or other foreign material. When jammed, the row unit equipment stops operating.

[0005] Therefore, in order to protect the combine harvester, the header, and the row unit equipment, a slip clutch is used to connect the row unit equipment to the drive shaft. Therefore, when any of the row unit equipment or the chopper becomes jammed, the slip clutch begins to slip so that equipment is disengaged from the drive shaft by the slip clutch. This disengagement permits the drive shaft to continue rotating even though the row unit equipment or chopper is jammed, and is not operating.

[0006] The discussion above is merely provided for general background information and is not intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter.

SUMMARY

[0007] A vibration sensor is mounted to a corn head of an agricultural harvester. The vibration sensor generates a sensor signal indicative of sensed vibrations on the corn head. The sensor signal is converted to a digital signal and a bandpass filter is applied to filter out signals in frequency ranges that do not represent slip clutch impulses. The filtered signal is demodulated to better identify the slip impulses generated when the slip clutch is slipping. The demodulated signal is transformed to a frequency domain signal and an input frequency is calculated based upon the speed of rotation of the drive shaft (or an expected range of speeds), the slip clutch configuration, and a gear ratio of a gear box between the drive shaft and the slip clutch. The power in parts of the

frequency domain signal that are within a desired range of the input frequency is compared to a threshold power value to determine whether a slip clutch is slipping. A slip status signal, indicative of whether a slip clutch is slipping, is output. A control signal is generated based upon the slip status.

[0008] Example 1 is a computer implemented method, comprising: [0009] receiving a sensor signal from a vibration sensor mounted on a frame of an agricultural header that has a drive shaft that transmits power to a row unit through a slip clutch; [0010] converting the sensor signal to a digital signal; [0011] applying a bandpass filter to the digital signal to obtain a filtered signal; [0012] demodulating the filtered signal to obtain a demodulated signal; [0013] transforming the demodulated signal to a frequency domain signal; [0014] obtaining an input frequency value indicative of a frequency at which vibrations are induced on the frame of the agricultural header when the slip clutch is slipping; [0015] comparing a power of the frequency domain signal, within a range of the input frequency, to a threshold power value to obtain a comparison result; and [0016] generating a slip status output indicative of whether the slip clutch is slipping based on the comparison result.

[0017] Example 2 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein obtaining an input frequency comprises: [0018] sensing a speed of rotation of the drive shaft; and [0019] computing the input frequency based on the sensed speed of rotation of the drive shaft.

[0020] Example 3 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein obtaining an input frequency comprises: [0021] obtaining a slip clutch configuration indicator indicative of a configuration of the slip clutch; and [0022] computing the input frequency based on the configuration of the slip clutch.

[0023] Example 4 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein the slip clutch has a physical configuration that determines a rate at which vibrations are induced on the frame when the slip clutch is slipping, given a frequency of rotation of the drive shaft, and wherein obtaining a slip clutch configuration comprises: [0024] obtaining the physical configuration of the slip clutch.

[0025] Example 5 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein the drive shaft transmits power to the row unit through a gear assembly having a gear ratio and wherein obtaining an input frequency comprises: [0026] computing the input frequency based on the gear ratio of the gear assembly.

[0027] Example 6 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein obtaining an input frequency comprises: [0028] obtaining an expected range of speeds of rotation of the drive shaft; and [0029] computing a set of input frequencies based on the expected range of speeds of rotation of the drive shaft.

[0030] Example 7 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein comparing a power of the frequency domain signal to a threshold power value to obtain a comparison result comprises: [0031] comparing a power of the frequency domain signal, within a range of the set of input frequencies, to a threshold power value to obtain the comparison result.

[0032] Example 8 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples and further comprising: [0033] determining validity of the slip status output based on a validity criterion; and [0034] generating a control signal based on the validity of the slip status output.

[0035] Example 9 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein determining validity of the slip status output comprises: [0036] detecting a characteristic of engagement of the drive shaft; and [0037] determining the validity of the slip status output based on the characteristic of engagement of the drive shaft.

[0038] Example 10 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein generating a control signal comprises: [0039] generating the control signal to control an operator interface based on the slip status output.

[0040] Example 11 is the computer implemented method of any or all previous examples wherein

generating a control signal comprises: [0041] generating the control signal to control header functionality or harvester functionality based on the slip status output.

[0042] Example 12 is an agricultural system, comprising: [0043] an agricultural harvester; [0044] a header coupled to the agricultural harvester, the header having a frame, a drive shaft, a plurality of row units, and a plurality of slip clutches, the drive shaft being configured to transmit power to each row unit, of the plurality of row units, through a separate slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches; [0045] a vibration sensor mounted on the frame of the header, configured to generate a sensor signal indicative of sensed vibrations; [0046] a signal processing system configured to convert the sensor signal to a digital signal, bandpass filter the digital signal to obtain a filtered signal, demodulate the filtered signal to obtain a demodulated signal, and transform the demodulated signal to a frequency domain signal; [0047] an input frequency calculation processor configured to obtain an input frequency value indicative of a frequency at which vibrations occur on the frame of the header when a slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, is slipping; [0048] a threshold comparison processor configured to compare a power of the frequency domain signal, within a range of the input frequency, to a threshold power value to obtain a comparison result; and [0049] a slip status output system configured to generate a slip status output indicative of whether the slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, is slipping based on the comparison result.

[0050] Example 13 is the agricultural system of any or all previous examples and further comprising: [0051] a drive shaft speed sensor configured to sense a speed of rotation of the drive shaft, the input frequency calculation processor being configured to compute the input frequency based on the sensed speed of rotation of the drive shaft.

[0052] Example 14 is the agricultural system of any or all previous examples wherein the input frequency calculation processor is configured to obtain a slip clutch configuration indicator indicative of a configuration of the slip clutch and compute the input frequency based on the configuration of the slip clutch.

[0053] Example 15 is the agricultural system of any or all previous examples wherein the slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, has a physical configuration that determines a rate at which vibrations are produced on the frame when the slip clutch is slipping, given a frequency of rotation of the drive shaft, and wherein the input frequency calculation processor is configured to compute the input frequency based on the physical configuration of the slip clutch.

[0054] Example 16 is the agricultural system of any or all previous examples and further comprising: [0055] a gear assembly, having a gear ratio, coupled to transmit power from the drive shaft to the row unit the input frequency calculation processor being configured to compute the input frequency based on the gear ratio of the gear assembly.

[0056] Example 17 is the agricultural system of any or all previous examples and further comprising: [0057] an interlock processor configured to determine a validity of the slip status output based on a validity criterion; and [0058] a control signal generator configured to generate a control signal based on the validity of the slip status output.

[0059] Example 18 is an agricultural system, comprising: [0060] an agricultural harvester; [0061] a header coupled to the agricultural harvester, the header having a frame, a drive shaft, a plurality of row units, and a plurality of slip clutches, the drive shaft being configured to transmit power to each row unit, of the plurality of row units, through a separate slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches; [0062] a vibration sensor mounted on the frame of the header, configured to generate a sensor signal indicative of sensed vibrations; [0063] a signal processing system configured to convert the sensor signal to a digital signal, bandpass filter the digital signal to obtain a filtered signal, demodulate the filtered signal to obtain a demodulated signal, and transform the demodulated signal to a frequency domain signal; [0064] a slip detection system configured to generate a slip status output indicative of whether the slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, is slipping based on the frequency domain signal.

[0065] Example 19 is the agricultural system of any or all previous examples wherein the slip

detection system comprises: [0066] an input frequency calculation processor configured to obtain an input frequency value indicative of a frequency at which vibrations occur on the frame of the header when a slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, is slipping.

[0067] Example 20 is the agricultural system of any or all previous examples wherein the slip detection system comprises: [0068] a threshold comparison processor configured to compare a power of the frequency domain signal, within a range of the input frequency, to a threshold power value to obtain a comparison result; and [0069] a slip status output system configured to generate the slip status output based on the comparison result.

[0070] This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter. The claimed subject matter is not limited to implementations that solve any or all disadvantages noted in the background.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0071] FIG. 1 is a pictorial illustration of an agricultural system including an agricultural harvester with a corn head.

[0072] FIG. 2 is a block diagram showing one example of the agricultural system in more detail.

[0073] FIGS. 3A, 3B and 3C (collectively referred to herein as FIG. 3) show a flow diagram illustrating one example of the operation of the agricultural system in detecting clutch slips.

[0074] FIG. 4 is a block diagram showing one example of the agricultural system deployed in a remote server environment.

[0075] FIGS. 5-7 show examples of mobile devices that can be used in the architectures and systems shown in other figures.

[0076] FIG. 8 is a block diagram of a computing environment that can be used in architectures and systems shown in other figures.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0077] As discussed above, it is not uncommon for an agricultural harvester corn head to have row units with row unit equipment that becomes jammed and that ceases to operate. Therefore, slip clutches are provided between the drive shaft that transmits power to the row unit equipment and each of the row units. Thus, when a row unit becomes jammed, the slip clutch for that row unit begins to slip so the drive shaft can continue to rotate even though the row unit equipment does not continue to operate. The jammed row unit equipment is thus isolated from the drive shaft by the slip clutch. This helps to protect both the agricultural harvester and the row unit equipment from damage. Also, this allows the other row units which are not jammed to continue to operate.

[0078] However, it is undesirable to allow a slip clutch to continue to slip for a lengthy period of time. A slipping slip clutch causes increased heat and additional wear on the slip clutch. This can result in damage to the slip clutch itself in as little as a few minutes time. Further, while the slip clutch is slipping, the corresponding row unit is not operating. Therefore, if the harvester continues advancing along the field, the row that is intended to be harvested by the jammed row unit will not be harvested, thus leaving unharvested crop in the field.

[0079] This problem can be exacerbated because an operator of the agricultural harvester often cannot see that a clutch is slipping. Further, in autonomous scenarios, there may not even be a human operator in the agricultural harvester, making clutch slip detection even more difficult.

[0080] Some current systems have attempted to perform automatic clutch slip detection by sensing vibrations on the corn head, performing an analog to digital conversion on the sensor signal and running that signal through a bandpass filter. The magnitude of the amplitude of the filtered signal

is compared against a threshold value to determine whether a clutch slip is occurring. However, this can lead to erroneous slip detection. For instance, the parameters of the bandpass filter are dependent on the frequency of rotation of the drive shaft. Thus, the parameters of the bandpass filter must vary with the frequency of rotation of the drive shaft, or the proper frequency band will not be passed through the filter. Similarly, the amplitude modulated nature of the current slip clutch detectors can have reduced accuracy when other components of the header, or terrain, are inducing vibrations.

[0081] The present discussion thus proceeds with respect to a slip clutch detection system that senses vibrations on the header, performs bandpass filtering and then demodulates the filtered signal to better capture clutch slip impulses. A Fast Fourier Transformation is performed on the demodulated signal to transform the signal into the frequency domain. Regardless of whether the drive shaft speed is known, an input frequency is calculated based upon either the known drive shaft speed or a range of expected drive shaft speeds, based upon the slip clutch configuration, and based upon a gear ratio that is used between the drive shaft and the row unit equipment. The frequency domain signal is evaluated. More specifically, in one example, the power in the frequency bins of the frequency domain signal that are within a desired frequency range of the input frequency is then compared to a threshold power value in order to determine a slip status.

[0082] The slip status indicates whether a slip clutch is slipping. The slip status can be verified using any of a variety of different interlocks, and a control signal can be generated based upon the verified slip status. The present description thus describes a system with enhanced slip detection accuracy even in noisy environments.

[0083] FIG. 1 is a pictorial illustration of an agricultural system **100** in which an agricultural harvester **102** has a corn head **104** attached thereto. The corn head **104** has a plurality of snouts **106** that serve to divide the rows of corn and direct the corn stalks in the rows into the row unit equipment (which may include gathering chains, snap rolls, choppers, etc. One or more drive shafts **108** are powered by a power takeoff on agricultural harvester **102** and drive rotation of a row unit drive shaft **112** through one or more gear boxes **114**. The row unit drive shaft **112** drives rotation of the row unit equipment. It will be appreciated that there can be more than one drive shaft **108** and more than one row unit drive shaft **112** for driving different sets of the row unit equipment. A single drive shaft **108** and row unit drive shaft **112** that is used to drive all of the row unit equipment is shown in FIG. 1 for the sake of example only.

[0084] Agricultural harvester **102** can proceed through a field in the direction generally indicated by arrow **124**. As agricultural harvester **102** proceeds in the direction indicated by arrow **124**, the different row units on header **104** engage the crop and process the crop rows.

[0085] Also, in the example shown in FIG. 1, drive shaft **108** drives an auger **116**. As ears of corn are removed from stalks by the row unit equipment, those ears of corn are directed to a central opening in header **104** and a separate conveyor feeds the ears of corn through that opening (generally in the direction indicated by arrow **118**) into a feeder house **120** of agricultural harvester **102**. The feeder house **120** may accelerate the harvested ears of corn into additional harvesting mechanisms that are located within agricultural harvester **102**.

[0086] As discussed above, it may happen that one or more of row units have equipment that becomes jammed so that it no longer operates. Therefore, a plurality of different slip clutches are mounted between row unit drive shaft **112** and the row unit equipment (such as the drive mechanisms that drive the gathering chains, the snap rolls, the choppers, etc.). If the row unit equipment on one of the row units becomes jammed, then the corresponding slip clutch **122** begins to slip, thus isolating that jammed row unit equipment from the drive shaft **112**, and from drive shaft **108**, and gear boxes **114**, on header **104**. This allows the remaining row units on header **104** to continue operating, even while one of the row units is jammed.

[0087] Also, as discussed above, it can be harmful to allow a slip clutch **122** to keep slipping for an extended period of time. Therefore, in the example illustrated in FIG. 1, agricultural system **100**

includes one or more acceleration sensors **126-128**, which may be mounted on a frame that carries the row units and supports row unit drive shaft **112**. While a single acceleration sensor may be used, or any number of acceleration sensors, the present discussion proceeds with respect to an acceleration sensor **126** on one end of header **104** and one acceleration sensor **128** on another end of header **104**, although this is only one example.

[0088] A slip clutch detection system **130** receives sensor signals **132** from the acceleration sensors **126-128** and processes those sensor signals to identify when a slip clutch **122** is slipping. In one example, slip clutch detection system **130** generates an output to an operator interface **133** on agricultural harvester **102**. The operator interface **133** may be an audio, visual, and/or haptic interface that provides an alarm that is observable by an operator. In another example, slip clutch detection system **130** may generate a control signal **134** that can be used to control functionality on agricultural harvester **102** and/or header **104**. For instance, the control signal **134** may cause agricultural harvester **102** to stop, and/or to stop the power takeoff driving drive shaft **108** until the jam can be cleared. Control signal **134** may control functions on header **104** to reverse the gathering chains in order to assist in clearing the jam. Also, the slip clutch detection system **130** may generate an output to operator interface **133** or elsewhere identifying which particular slip clutch is slipping, which particular row unit is jammed, among other things. These are only examples of the output from slip clutch detection system **130**, and other outputs can be generated as well.

[0089] Before describing the operation of slip clutch detection system **130** in more detail, a brief description of the examples of different types of slip clutches **122** will first be provided. In one example, the slip clutch includes two plates that have opposing faces. A set of spring biased pins are disposed in apertures on one of the faces and biased outwardly to engage grooves or openings in the other of the two faces. When the clutch is slipping, the pins retract against the spring bias into the apertures so that one of the plates can keep rotating relative to the other plate. This results in the spring bias pins reciprocating inwardly and outwardly, as the faces rotate relative to one another, and as the clutch continues to slip. In another example, the slip clutches may be star-type slip clutches in which a pair of plates have radially extending ridges which define grooves therebetween. The two plates are spring biased into engagement with one another as one plate is stopped and the other plate continues to rotate. When experiencing excessive torque, the springs yield and the ridges on the two opposing plates “chatter” against one another. Therefore, in both of these types of slip clutches, the vibrations caused when the clutch is slipping are generally periodic and have a repetition rate at a predominant or fundamental frequency that is a product of the rotational speed of the clutch and the number of ridges or pins. The vibrations may also occur at overtone frequencies of diminishing magnitude. There are various other types of slip clutches that also have teeth or lobes or other detents that engage one another and thus similarly generate vibrations at a fundamental or predominant frequency that is a product of the frequency of rotation of the slip clutch and the number of teeth, lobes or detents.

[0090] FIG. 2 is a block diagram showing one example of agricultural system **100** in more detail. In the example shown in FIG. 2, agricultural system **100** includes one or more processors or servers **150**, data store **152**, communication system **153**, sensors **154**, slip clutch detection system **130**, control signal generator **156**, power take off system **158**, transmission **160**, row unit equipment **161**, auger **116**, controllable subsystems **162**, and/or other agricultural system functionality **164**. Data store **152** can include header characteristics **166**, algorithm parameters **167**, and other items **168**. Sensors **154** can include header characteristic sensor(s) **170**, acceleration sensor(s) **126-128**, drive shaft speed detector **174**, and any of a wide variety of other sensors **176**. Slip clutch detection system **130** can include signal processing system **178**, slip detection system **180**, interlock processor **182**, and other items **184**. Signal processing system **178** can include analog-to-digital converter **186**, bandpass filter **188**, demodulation system **190**, Fast Fourier Transformation system **192**, and other items **194**. Slip detection system **180** can include slip clutch input frequency

calculation processor **196**, operating input frequency calculation processor **198**, threshold comparison processor **200**, slip clutch identification system **202**, slip status output system **204**, and other items **206**. Transmission **160** can include drive shaft **108**, gear assembly **114**, slip clutches **122**, and other items **208**. Row unit equipment **161** can include gathering chains **210**, snap rolls **212**, choppers **214**, and other items **216**. Controllable subsystems **162** can include operator interface system **218**, controllable head functionality **220**, and other controllable machine functionality **222**. Before describing the operation of agricultural system **100** in more detail, a description of some of the items in agricultural system **100**, and their operation, will first be described.

[0091] Communication system **153** can enable communication of the items in agricultural system **100** with one another and may also enable communication with other machines, other systems, cloud-based systems, among other things. Communication system **153** may thus be a controller area network (CAN) bus and bus controller, a communication system that facilitates communication over a cellular network, a wide area network, a local area network, a near-field communication network, a wifi or Bluetooth network, among other things.

[0092] Header characteristics **166** can be detected by header characteristic sensor(s) **170** or received over a communication system **153**, received through operator interface system **218**, or received in other ways. Header characteristics **166** may characterize header **104** and include such things as the type of frame used on header **104** (a rigid frame, or a folding frame), the number of rows processed by header **104**, whether header **104** is configured with choppers **214**, the gear ratio between the drive shaft **108** and slip clutches **102**, and the slip clutch configuration of slip clutches **122** (such as the number of pins, the number of teeth or extending ridges, or other configuration information).

[0093] Header characteristic sensor(s) **170** can be mounted to harvester **102** and/or header **104** to sense the header characteristics **166**. Header characteristic sensor(s) **170** can also sense operational characteristics of header **104** such as whether the drive shaft **108** is engaged, whether drive shaft **108** is rotating in a forward or reverse direction, the direction that the row unit equipment **161** is running, among other things. Thus, header characteristic sensor(s) **170** may be Hall Effect sensors, potentiometers, or other sensors. Acceleration sensors **126-128** can be accelerometers or other vibration sensors. It will be noted that the signal processing system **178**, or some of the items in signal processing system **178**, may be located on acceleration sensors **126-128**. The signal processing system **178** is shown separately from acceleration sensors **126-128** for the sake of example only. Drive shaft speed detector **174** detects the speed of drive shaft **108** and/or other drive shafts on header **104**. Drive shaft speed detector **174** can be a Hall Effect sensor, a sensor that senses the speed of the power takeoff system **158** that is driving drive shaft **108**, or any of a wide variety of other detectors that can detect the rotational speed of drive shaft **108**.

[0094] Analog-to-digital converter **186** can be any type of analog-to-digital converter **186** that can convert the signals from acceleration sensors **126-128** into a digital signal. Bandpass filter **188** may be a variable bandpass filter that varies the pass band based upon the speed of drive shaft **108** sensed by drive shaft speed detector **174**. In another example, bandpass filter **188** may be multiple different bandpass filters that are switched into and out of processing the signal output by analog-to-digital converter **186** based upon the speed detected by drive shaft speed detector **174**.

[0095] In yet another example, bandpass filter **188** is arranged to pass a band of frequencies wide enough to cover the expected frequencies of rotation of drive shaft **108**. The bandpass filter **188** may be a Butterworth filter, a Chebyshev filter, an elliptic filter, or another filter. The order of the bandpass filter **188** can be chosen empirically to fit the characteristics of header **104** and other hardware used in agricultural system **100**, or chosen in another way.

[0096] Demodulation system **190** demodulates the filtered signal provided by bandpass filter **188**. Demodulation system **190** performs an enveloping operation which down samples the original frequency of the filtered signal, because the frequency of interest will normally be much lower than

the original frequency. Demodulation system **190** may implement any of a wide variety of enveloping methods, such as a Hilbert demodulator, a finite impulse response (FIR) filter, a root mean square (RMS) demodulation system, a peak demodulation system, among others. Fast Fourier Transformation system **192** can implement any of a wide variety of transformation algorithms, such as the Cooley Tukey algorithm, or other algorithms, that transform the modulated signal into the frequency domain.

[0097] Slip clutch input frequency calculation processor **196** calculates a frequency at which slip clutch impulses or vibrations detected by acceleration sensors **126-128** are expected, if a slip clutch **126-128** is slipping. Where drive shaft speed detector **174** detects the rotational velocity of drive shaft **108**, then slip clutch input frequency calculation processor **196** calculates a slip clutch input frequency as follows:

[00001] $\text{Slipclutchinputfrequency}(F_{IL}) = F_{\text{driveshaft}} * N * \text{GearRatio}$ EQ. 1 [0098] Where $F_{\text{drive shaft}}$ is the frequency of drive shaft **108**; [0099] N is the number of pins or teeth on the slip clutch **122**; [0100] and [0101] Gear Ratio is the Gear Ratio between the drive shaft **108** and the shaft used to drive the row unit equipment, on which slip clutch **122** is deployed.

[0102] Where the speed of drive shaft **108** is not available (such as where no drive shaft speed detector **174** is used), then operating input frequency calculation processor **198** calculates a frequency range, based upon the expected frequencies of rotation of drive shaft **108**, as follows:

[00002] $\text{Operatinginputfrequency} F_{IS} = F_{\text{driveshaftmin / max}} * N * \text{GearRatio}$ EQ. 2 [0103] where $F_{\text{sub.drive shaft min/max}}$ represents the minimum and maximum expected frequencies of rotations of drive shaft **108**.

[0104] Threshold comparison processor **200** then identifies the energy level in the frequency bins output by Fast Fourier Transformation system **192** that are within a desired range of either the slip clutch input frequency (calculated as set out in EQ. 1 above) or the operating input frequency (calculated as set out in EQ. 2 above) to a threshold energy value. If the energy values in the frequency bins meet the threshold energy value, then this indicates that a slip clutch **122** is slipping. If the energy values in the frequency bins do not meet the threshold value, then this indicates that no slip clutch **122** is slipping.

[0105] In the example shown in FIG. 2, slip detection system **180** can also include a slip clutch identification system **202**. Slip clutch identification system **202** can be configured to identify the particular slip clutch **122** that is slipping (or a set of slip clutches **122** that includes the particular slip clutch **122** that is slipping). For instance, each of the slip clutches **122** may be provided with a different number of teeth or reciprocating pins. In that case, the slip clutch input frequency calculation processor **196** can calculate a different slip clutch input frequency corresponding to each of the different slip clutches **122**, and operating input frequency calculation processor **198** can also calculate a different operating input frequency corresponding to each of the different slip clutches **122**. Threshold comparison processor **200** can determine whether the energy values in the different energy bins meet thresholds, where the frequency bins will vary by slip clutch **122**. Thus, each slip clutch **122** will have a corresponding, separate set of frequency bins. The frequency bins corresponding to each slip clutch **122** will be checked to determine whether that slip clutch **122** is slipping. In this way, slip detection system **180** can check to determine whether each individual slip clutch **122** is slipping and slip clutch identification system **202** can identify that particular slip clutch **122** based upon the particular frequency bins that are found to have a threshold energy value. In another example, the power spectral density (the power of the frequency domain signal) is stronger when the slipping clutch **122** is closer to the vibration sensor(s) **126-128**. Therefore, the power spectral density can be used to identify which slip clutches **122** are slipping. In another example, the particular slip clutch **122** that is slipping need not be identified or may be identified in another way.

[0106] Slip status output system **204** generates an output signal indicating whether a slip clutch **122**

is slipping. In addition, where the particular slip clutch **122** is identified, then slip status output system **204** also provide an output identifying which particular slip clutch **122** is slipping. [0107] Interlock processor **182** can apply one or more different interlocks to validate the slip status. For instance, if the header **104** is not engaged (e.g., if the drive shaft **108** is not engaged) then the slip status will not be verified. Similarly, if the drive shaft **108** is not engaged in the forward direction, then the slip status will not be verified. In yet another example, interlock processor **182** may verify the slip status based upon whether other harvesting functionality (such as the separator in agricultural harvester **102**) is operating.

[0108] If interlock processor **182** verifies a slip status indicating that a slip clutch **122** is slipping, then interlock processor **182** generates an output to control signal generator **156**. Control signal generator **156** generates a control signal based upon the verified slip status. For instance, control signal generator **156** can generate a control signal to control operator interface system **218** to generate an output on operator interface **132** to indicate to an operator that a slip clutch **122** is slipping. The output may be an audio, visual, or haptic output. Control signal generator **156** may also generate an output to control any controllable head functionality **220** or other controllable machine functionality **222** on agricultural harvester **102**. These are examples and other control signals can be generated as well.

[0109] FIG. 2 also shows that agricultural harvester **102** may include a power takeoff system **158** that drives a transmission **160**. Transmission **160** drives row unit equipment **161**. The transmission **160** may include drive shaft **108**, gear box assembly **114**, slip clutches **122**, and other items **208**. Transmission **160** may drive row unit equipment **161** which, can include gathering chains **210**, snap rolls **212**, choppers **214**, and/or other items **216**. FIG. 2 also shows that transmission **160** can drive auger **116**.

[0110] FIGS. 3A, 3B and 3C (collectively referred to herein as FIG. 3) show a flow diagram illustrating one example of the operation of agricultural system **100** in detecting a clutch slip of a slip clutch **122**. It is first assumed that a slip clutch **122** is deployed on the header to protect the row unit equipment on the header, as indicated by block **250** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. In one example, a slip clutch **122** is deployed on each row unit, as indicated by block **252**. The slip clutches **122** can be deployed in other ways, such as to protect sets of row units, or in other ways, as indicated by block **254**. It is also assumed that an acceleration sensor **126-128** is deployed on header **104**, as indicated by block **256** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. The acceleration sensor **126-128** can be deployed on one side of header **104**, or on both sides, as indicated by block **258**, or in other locations, as indicated by block **260**.

[0111] At some point, slip clutch detection system **130** obtains characteristics of header **104** that will be used to determine whether a slip clutch **122** is slipping. Obtaining header characteristics is indicated by block **262** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. As discussed above, the header characteristics can be detected by header characteristic sensor(s) **170** or received through communication system **153** or through operator interface system **218** in other ways, and stored as header characteristics **166** in data store **152**. Detecting or receiving an input indicative of the header characteristics **166** is indicated by block **264** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3.

[0112] Further, slip clutch detection system **130** obtains algorithm parameters **167** that are to be used to detect slipping, as identified by block **263**. The parameters **167** can be calculated off line (e.g., in a remote server environment or elsewhere). The parameters **167** can be independent of the header characteristics **166** as indicated by block **265** and can include such things as threshold values **267**, and/or other values **269**.

[0113] The header characteristics **166** can include a frame type, such as whether the frame of header **104** is rigid, or folding, as indicated by block **266**. The header characteristics **166** can include the size (in terms of the number of rows) of header **104**, as indicated by block **268**. The header characteristics **166** can indicate whether header **104** is configured as a chopping header or a non-chopping header, as indicated by block **270**. The header characteristics **166** can also include

the gear ratio of the gears between the drive shaft **108** and row unit equipment **161** as indicated by block **272** in the flow diagram of FIG. **3**. The header characteristics **166** can also include the slip clutch configuration, such as the number of pins or teeth (N) on the slip clutches **122** as indicated by block **274**. The header characteristics **166** can include other characteristics as well, as indicated by block **276**.

[0114] Analog-to-digital converter **186** samples the acceleration signal generated by acceleration sensors **126-128** at a sampling rate that is higher than the frequency of the clutch slip impulses, as indicated by block **278** in the flow diagram of FIG. **3**. For instance, the clutch slip impulses may occur at a frequency in a range of 50 Hz-100 Hz, for example, and the sampling rate is much higher than that, as indicated by block **280**. In one example, where the clutch slip impulses will occur at a frequency of 50-100 Hertz, then the sampling rate may be 20 KHz, as just one example. Sampling the acceleration signal at a high sampling rate, such as 20 KHz, is indicated by block **282** in the flow diagram of FIG. **3**. The sampling rate can be any of a wide variety of other sampling rates as well, as indicated by block **284**.

[0115] Analog-to-digital converter **186** performs an analog-to-digital conversion on the sampled acceleration signal, as indicated by block **286**. The digital signal is then filtered by bandpass filter **188**, as indicated by block **288** in the flow diagram of FIG. **3**. During normal harvesting conditions, when no clutches **122** are slipping, there are a combination of vibrations, such as noise and drive chain vibrations and other sources, that cause vibrations at a beat frequency. The energy content at such frequencies may be relatively strong so that the energy content interferes with detection of slip impulses. Therefore, the parameters (e.g., the order and pass band) of bandpass filter **188** may be based upon the characteristics of header **104** and/or agricultural harvester **102**. The characteristics of header **104** may include the normal harvesting vibration energy band and the energy band of the clutch slip impulses. Providing a bandpass filter with parameters that are based on machine characteristics is indicated by block **290** in the flow diagram of FIG. **3**. In one example, bandpass filter **188** is dynamically variable based on whether the drive shaft speed is known, as indicated by block **292** in the flow diagram of FIG. **3**. For instance, if the drive shaft speed is known, then bandpass filter **188** can pass a frequency band that includes desired set of frequencies that will be proportional to the frequency of rotation of the drive shaft **108**. However, if the drive shaft speed is not known, then bandpass filter **188** may pass a wider band of frequencies corresponding to the expected maximum and minimum rotation frequencies of drive shaft **108**. The bandpass filter **188** filters out header noise but passes the frequency band that will be carrying the slip impulses generated by a slip clutch **122** that is slipping, as indicated by block **294**. The bandpass filter **188** can be applied in other ways as well, as indicated by block **296**.

[0116] Demodulation system **190** then demodulates the filtered signal provided by bandpass filter **188**. Demodulating the filtered signal is indicated by block **298** in the flow diagram of FIG. **3**. Demodulation reduces the frequency content of the signal to better isolate and capture the slip impulses, as indicated by block **300**. In one example, the demodulation system **190** executes an RMS window enveloping algorithm, as indicated by block **302**. The demodulation system **190** can also be a Hilbert demodulator, a finite impulse response demodulator, a peak demodulator, or another demodulator as indicated by block **304**.

[0117] Fast Fourier Transformation system **192** performs a transformation on the demodulated signal to transform the demodulated signal to the frequency domain, as indicated by block **306**. Fast Fourier Transformation (FFT) system **192** can run the Cooley Tukey algorithm as indicated by block **308**, or perform another frequency domain transformation, as indicated by block **310**.

[0118] Slip clutch detection system **180** detects whether the drive shaft speed is available from drive shaft speed detector **174**, as indicated by block **312**. If so, then slip clutch input frequency calculation processor **196** computes the slip clutch input frequency (FIL) based upon the drive shaft speed, the slip clutch configuration (such as the number of teeth or pins (N) in the slip clutch), and the gear ratio between the drive shaft **108** and the slip clutch **122**, as indicated by block **314** in the

flow diagram of FIG. 3. FIL can be computed according to EQ. 1 above, as indicated by block **316** in FIG. 3, or in another way, as indicated by block **318** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3.

[0119] Threshold comparison processor **200** then compares the power in the FFT bins generated by FFT system **192** that are within a desired range of FIL (such as within + or -5 Hz of FIL or within another desired range) to a threshold power value, as indicated by block **320** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. The desired range of frequencies may be determined empirically or in another way. Also, the threshold power value can also be identified empirically, or based upon the characteristics of header **104**, or the characteristics of agricultural harvester **102**, in other ways.

[0120] Based upon that comparison, slip status output system **204** generates a slip status indicating whether a clutch slip is occurring, as indicated by block **322** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. For instance, if the power in the FFT bins meets the threshold power value, then slip status output system **204** may generate an output indicating that the slip status is positive, or that a clutch slip is occurring, as indicated by block **324**. If the power in the FFT bins does not meet the threshold power value, then slip status output system **204** may generate an output indicating that a clutch slip is not occurring, as indicated by block **326** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. Where slip clutch identification system **202** is used, then the slip status output system **204** can generate the slip status to also indicate which slip clutch **122** is slipping, as indicated by block **328** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. Slip status output system **204** can generate an output indicative of the slip status in other ways as well, as indicated by block **330**.

[0121] The slip status output may be provided to interlock processor **182** which applies interlocks to the slip status to determine whether the slip status is valid. Applying interlocks is indicated by block **332** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. For instance, header characteristic sensor(s) **170** may generate a signal indicating whether the header **104** is engaged (in that the drive shaft **108** is running). If not, then the slip status is irrelevant and thus interlock processor **112** identifies the slip status as being invalid. Detecting the validity of the slip status based on upon whether the header **104** is engaged is indicated by block **334** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3.

[0122] Header characteristic sensor **170** may also detect whether the header **104** is engaged in the forward direction (e.g., the row units have not been reversed, such as to clear a jam, or for another reason). If the header **104** is not engaged in the forward direction then, again, the slip status is not valid. Detecting the validity of the slip status based upon whether the header **104** is engaged in the forward direction is indicated by block **336** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3.

[0123] Interlock processor **182** may apply other interlocks as well. For instance, other sensors **176** may sense whether the separator in agricultural harvester **102** is engaged or whether any of the other harvesting functionality on agricultural harvester **102** is engaged. If not, this can also mean that the slip status is invalid. Detecting the validity of slip status based upon whether the separator is engaged (or, indeed, based upon whether other harvesting functionality on agricultural harvester **102** is engaged) is indicated by block **338** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. Other interlocks can be applied as well, as indicated by block **340** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3.

[0124] If the slip status is invalid, as determined by interlock processor **182** at block **342** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3, then the slip status is simply ignored, as indicated by block **344**. However, if, at block **342**, interlock processor **182** determines that the slip status is valid, then interlock processor **182** generates an output to control signal generator **156** indicating the slip status, and that the slip status is valid. Control signal generator **156** generates an action signal (such as a control signal) based upon the slip status. Generating an action signal is indicated by block **346** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. The action signal or control signal can be used to control any of a wide variety of controllable subsystems **162**. For instance, the control signal generated by control signal generator **156** can be used to control operator interface system **218** to control a display or other output mechanism that may alert an operator of agricultural harvester **102** that a slip is occurring, the location of the slip, and other information (such as how long the slip has occurred). Controlling a display or other output mechanism based upon a valid slip status is indicated by block **348** in the

flow diagram of FIG. 3. The control signal generated by control signal generator **156** can also be used to control a variety of different types of controllable head functionality **220**, as indicated by block **350**, or a variety of different controllable machine functionality **222**, as indicated by block **352** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. The control signal generator **156** can generate the control signal in other ways, to control other functionality as well, as indicated by block **354**.

[0125] Returning again to block **312** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3, if slip detection system determines that the drive shaft speed is not available, then operating input frequency calculation processor **198** computes the operating input frequency FIS based upon an expected frequencies of rotation of drive shaft **108**, based upon the slip clutch configuration, and based upon the gear ratio. For instance FIS can be computed based upon a maximum expected drive shaft speed and FIS can also be computed based upon a minimum drive shaft speed. Computing FIS based upon a range of drive shaft speeds is indicated by block **356** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. In one example, FIS is computed as set out in EQ. 2 above, as indicated by block **358** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. FIS can be computed in other ways as well, as indicated by block **360**.

[0126] Once the FIS values are computed, then threshold comparison processor **200** compares the power in the frequency bins that are computed by FFT system **192** and that are within a desired frequency range of the FIS values to a threshold power value to determine whether a clutch slip is occurring. Comparing the power in the FFT bins to a threshold power value is indicated by block **362** in the flow diagram of FIG. 3. Based upon the comparison, processing continues at block **322** and following where a slip status is output, interlocks are applied, and control signals are generated for valid slip status values indicating that a clutch slip is occurring.

[0127] In one example, signal processing system **178** automatically adjusts the parameters of signal processing system **178** based on whether FIL, FIS, and/or the drive shaft frequency are available. If all information is available (such as on CAN messages), then the algorithm automatically examines a narrower frequency band with tighter thresholds. If some or all of the information is not available, then the algorithm automatically examines a wider frequency band with thresholds that are less tight. By automatically, it is meant, in one example, that the function or operation is performed without further human involvement except perhaps, to initiate or authorize the function or operation.

[0128] It can thus be seen that the present description proceeds with respect to a system that can identify clutch slip conditions even without knowing the drive shaft speed. Also, because the signal that is filtered by bandpass filter **188** is demodulated by demodulation system **190**, a large amount of the frequency content of the signal is removed so that clutch slip impulses can be identified more readily. Further, because the present description proceeds with respect to analysis of the clutch slip impulses in the frequency domain, clutch slips can be identified more accurately than in other systems.

[0129] The present discussion has mentioned processors and servers. In one example, the processors and servers include computer processors with associated memory and timing circuitry, not separately shown. The processors and servers are functional parts of the systems or devices to which the processors and servers belong and are activated by, and facilitate the functionality of the other components or items in those systems.

[0130] Also, a number of user interface (UI) displays have been discussed. The UI displays can take a wide variety of different forms and can have a wide variety of different user actuatable input mechanisms disposed thereon. For instance, the user actuatable input mechanisms can be text boxes, check boxes, icons, links, drop-down menus, search boxes, etc. The mechanisms can also be actuated in a wide variety of different ways. For instance, the mechanisms can be actuated using a point and click device (such as a track ball or mouse). The mechanisms can be actuated using hardware buttons, switches, a joystick or keyboard, thumb switches or thumb pads, etc. The mechanisms can also be actuated using a virtual keyboard or other virtual actuators. In addition, where the screen on which the mechanisms are displayed is a touch sensitive screen, the

mechanisms can be actuated using touch gestures. Also, where the device that displays them has speech recognition components, the mechanisms can be actuated using speech commands.

[0131] A number of data stores have also been discussed. It will be noted the data stores can each be broken into multiple data stores. All can be local to the systems accessing them, all can be remote, or some can be local while others are remote. All of these configurations are contemplated herein.

[0132] Also, the figures show a number of blocks with functionality ascribed to each block. It will be noted that fewer blocks can be used so the functionality is performed by fewer components. Also, more blocks can be used with the functionality distributed among more components.

[0133] It will be noted that the above discussion has described a variety of different systems, components, sensors, detectors, filters, converters, generators, and/or logic. It will be appreciated that such systems, components, sensors, detectors, filters, converters, generators, and/or logic can be comprised of hardware items (such as processors and associated memory, or other processing components, some of which are described below) that perform the functions associated with those systems, components, sensors, detectors, filters, converters, generators, and/or logic. In addition, the systems, components, sensors, detectors, filters, converters, generators, and/or logic can be comprised of software that is loaded into a memory and is subsequently executed by a processor or server, or other computing component, as described below. The systems, components, sensors, detectors, filters, converters, generators, and/or logic can also be comprised of different combinations of hardware, software, firmware, etc., some examples of which are described below. These are only some examples of different structures that can be used to form the systems, components, sensors, detectors, filters, converters, generators, and/or logic described above. Other structures can be used as well.

[0134] FIG. 4 is a block diagram of agricultural system **100**, shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, except that system **100** communicates with elements in a remote server architecture **500**. In an example, remote server architecture **500** can provide computation, software, data access, and storage services that do not require end-user knowledge of the physical location or configuration of the system that delivers the services. In various examples, remote servers can deliver the services over a wide area network, such as the internet, using appropriate protocols. For instance, remote servers can deliver applications over a wide area network and they can be accessed through a web browser or any other computing component. Software or components shown in previous FIGS. as well as the corresponding data, can be stored on servers at a remote location. The computing resources in a remote server environment can be consolidated at a remote data center location or they can be dispersed. Remote server infrastructures can deliver services through shared data centers, even though they appear as a single point of access for the user. Thus, the components and functions described herein can be provided from a remote server at a remote location using a remote server architecture. Alternatively, the components and functions can be provided from a conventional server, or they can be installed on client devices directly, or in other ways.

[0135] In the example shown in FIG. 4, some items are similar to those shown in previous FIGS. and those items are similarly numbered. FIG. 4 specifically shows that slip detection system **180**, data store **152**, and/or other systems **504** can be located at a remote server location **502**. Therefore, harvester **100** accesses those systems through remote server location **502**.

[0136] In one example, data analysis is performed in a non-real-time environment so the parameters of the detection algorithm can be computed to obtain values that work across different machine/header configurations. The parameters can then be downloaded for use in agricultural system **100** (e.g., the parameters can be stored in data store **152** and used during harvesting). In another example, the parameters can be fetched and consumed during runtime. Both scenarios are contemplated herein.

[0137] FIG. 4 also depicts another example of a remote server architecture. FIG. 4 shows that it is also contemplated that some elements of previous FIGS are disposed at remote server location **502**

while others are not. By way of example, data store **152** can be disposed at a location separate from location **502**, and accessed through the remote server at location **502**. Regardless of where the items are located, the items can be accessed directly by agricultural system **100**, through a network (either a wide area network or a local area network), the items can be hosted at a remote site by a service, or they can be provided as a service, or accessed by a connection service that resides in a remote location. All of these architectures are contemplated herein.

[0138] It will also be noted that the elements of previous FIGS., or portions of the elements, can be disposed on a wide variety of different devices. Some of those devices include servers, desktop computers, laptop computers, tablet computers, or other mobile devices, such as palm top computers, cell phones, smart phones, multimedia players, personal digital assistants, etc.

[0139] FIG. **5** is a simplified block diagram of one illustrative example of a handheld or mobile computing device that can be used as a user's or client's hand held device **16**, in which the present system (or parts of it) can be deployed. For instance, a mobile device can be deployed in the operator compartment of harvester **102** for use in generating, processing, or displaying the slip status data. FIGS. **5-7** are examples of handheld or mobile devices.

[0140] FIG. **5** provides a general block diagram of the components of a client device **16** that can run some components shown in previous FIGS., that interacts with the components, or both. In the device **16**, a communications link **13** is provided that allows the handheld device to communicate with other computing devices and under some examples provides a channel for receiving information automatically, such as by scanning. Examples of communications link **13** include allowing communication through one or more communication protocols, such as wireless services used to provide cellular access to a network, as well as protocols that provide local wireless connections to networks.

[0141] In other examples, applications can be received on a removable Secure Digital (SD) card that is connected to an interface **15**. Interface **15** and communication links **13** communicate with a processor **17** (which can also embody processors or servers from previous FIGS.) along a bus **19** that is also connected to memory **21** and input/output (I/O) components **23**, as well as clock **25** and location system **27**.

[0142] I/O components **23**, in one example, are provided to facilitate input and output operations. I/O components **23** for various examples of the device **16** can include input components such as buttons, touch sensors, optical sensors, microphones, touch screens, proximity sensors, accelerometers, orientation sensors and output components such as a display device, a speaker, and or a printer port. Other I/O components **23** can be used as well.

[0143] Clock **25** illustratively comprises a real time clock component that outputs a time and date. It can also, illustratively, provide timing functions for processor **17**.

[0144] Location system **27** illustratively includes a component that outputs a current geographical location of device **16**. Location system **27** can include, for instance, a global positioning system (GPS) receiver, a LORAN system, a dead reckoning system, a cellular triangulation system, or other positioning system. Location system **27** can also include, for example, mapping software or navigation software that generates desired maps, navigation routes and other geographic functions.

[0145] Memory **21** stores operating system **29**, network settings **31**, applications **33**, application configuration settings **35**, data store **37**, communication drivers **39**, and communication configuration settings **41**. Memory **21** can include all types of tangible volatile and non-volatile computer-readable memory devices. Memory **21** can also include computer storage media (described below). Memory **21** stores computer readable instructions that, when executed by processor **17**, cause the processor to perform computer-implemented steps or functions according to the instructions. Processor **17** can be activated by other components to facilitate their functionality as well.

[0146] FIG. **6** shows one example in which device **16** is a tablet computer **600**. In FIG. **6**, computer **600** is shown with user interface display screen **602**. Screen **602** can be a touch screen or a pen-

enabled interface that receives inputs from a pen or stylus. Computer **600** can also use an on-screen virtual keyboard. Of course, computer **600** might also be attached to a keyboard or other user input device through a suitable attachment mechanism, such as a wireless link or USB port, for instance. Computer **600** can also illustratively receive voice inputs as well.

[0147] FIG. **7** shows that the device can be a smart phone **71**. Smart phone **71** has a touch sensitive display **73** that displays icons or tiles or other user input mechanisms **75**. Mechanisms **75** can be used by a user to run applications, make calls, perform data transfer operations, etc. In general, smart phone **71** is built on a mobile operating system and offers more advanced computing capability and connectivity than a feature phone.

[0148] Note that other forms of the devices **16** are possible.

[0149] FIG. **8** is one example of a computing environment in which elements of previous FIGS., or parts of it, (for example) can be deployed. With reference to FIG. **8**, an example system for implementing some embodiments includes a computing device in the form of a computer **810** programmed to operate as described above. Components of computer **810** may include, but are not limited to, a processing unit **820** (which can comprise processors or servers from previous FIGS.), a system memory **830**, and a system bus **821** that couples various system components including the system memory to the processing unit **820**. The system bus **821** may be any of several types of bus structures including a memory bus or memory controller, a peripheral bus, and a local bus using any of a variety of bus architectures. Memory and programs described with respect to previous FIGS. can be deployed in corresponding portions of FIG. **8**.

[0150] Computer **810** typically includes a variety of computer readable media. Computer readable media can be any available media that can be accessed by computer **810** and includes both volatile and nonvolatile media, removable and non-removable media. By way of example, and not limitation, computer readable media may comprise computer storage media and communication media. Computer storage media is different from, and does not include, a modulated data signal or carrier wave. Computer storage media includes hardware storage media including both volatile and nonvolatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data. Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, RAM, ROM, EEPROM, flash memory or other memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (DVD) or other optical disk storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information and which can be accessed by computer **810**. Communication media may embody computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data in a transport mechanism and includes any information delivery media. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics set or changed in such a manner as to encode information in the signal.

[0151] The system memory **830** includes computer storage media in the form of volatile and/or nonvolatile memory such as read only memory (ROM) **831** and random access memory (RAM) **832**. A basic input/output system **833** (BIOS), containing the basic routines that help to transfer information between elements within computer **810**, such as during start-up, is typically stored in ROM **831**. RAM **832** typically contains data and/or program modules that are immediately accessible to and/or presently being operated on by processing unit **820**. By way of example, and not limitation, FIG. **8** illustrates operating system **834**, application programs **835**, other program modules **836**, and program data **837**.

[0152] The computer **810** may also include other removable/non-removable volatile/nonvolatile computer storage media. By way of example only, FIG. **8** illustrates a hard disk drive **841** that reads from or writes to non-removable, nonvolatile magnetic media, an optical disk drive **855**, and nonvolatile optical disk **856**. The hard disk drive **841** is typically connected to the system bus **821** through a non-removable memory interface such as interface **840**, and optical disk drive **855** are typically connected to the system bus **821** by a removable memory interface, such as interface **850**.

[0153] Alternatively, or in addition, the functionality described herein can be performed, at least in part, by one or more hardware logic components. For example, and without limitation, illustrative types of hardware logic components that can be used include Field-programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs), Application-specific Integrated Circuits (e.g., ASICs), Application-specific Standard Products (e.g., ASSPs), System-on-a-chip systems (SOCs), Complex Programmable Logic Devices (CPLDs), etc.

[0154] The drives and their associated computer storage media discussed above and illustrated in FIG. 8, provide storage of computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules and other data for the computer **810**. In FIG. 8, for example, hard disk drive **841** is illustrated as storing operating system **844**, application programs **845**, other program modules **846**, and program data **847**. Note that these components can either be the same as or different from operating system **834**, application programs **835**, other program modules **836**, and program data **837**.

[0155] A user may enter commands and information into the computer **810** through input devices such as a keyboard **862**, a microphone **863**, and a pointing device **861**, such as a mouse, trackball or touch pad. Other input devices (not shown) may include a joystick, game pad, satellite dish, scanner, or the like. These input devices and other input devices are often connected to the processing unit **820** through a user input interface **860** that is coupled to the system bus, but may be connected by other interface and bus structures. A visual display **891** or other type of display device is also connected to the system bus **821** via an interface, such as a video interface **890**. In addition to the monitor, computers may also include other peripheral output devices such as speakers **897** and printer **896**, which may be connected through an output peripheral interface **895**.

[0156] The computer **810** is operated in a networked environment using logical connections (such as a controller area network-CAN, local area network-LAN, or wide area network WAN) to one or more remote computers, such as a remote computer **880**.

[0157] When used in a LAN networking environment, the computer **810** is connected to the LAN **871** through a network interface or adapter **870**. When used in a WAN networking environment, the computer **810** typically includes a modem **872** or other means for establishing communications over the WAN **873**, such as the Internet. In a networked environment, program modules may be stored in a remote memory storage device. FIG. 8 illustrates, for example, that remote application programs **885** can reside on remote computer **880**.

[0158] It should also be noted that the different examples described herein can be combined in different ways. That is, parts of one or more examples can be combined with parts of one or more other examples. All of this is contemplated herein.

[0159] Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the specific features or acts described above. Rather, the specific features and acts described above are disclosed as example forms of implementing the claims.

Claims

1. A computer implemented method, comprising: receiving a sensor signal from a vibration sensor mounted on a frame of an agricultural header that has a drive shaft that transmits power to a row unit through a slip clutch; converting the sensor signal to a digital signal; applying a bandpass filter to the digital signal to obtain a filtered signal; demodulating the filtered signal to obtain a demodulated signal; transforming the demodulated signal to a frequency domain signal; obtaining an input frequency indicative of a frequency at which vibrations are induced on the frame of the agricultural header when the slip clutch is slipping; comparing a power of the frequency domain signal, within a range of the input frequency, to a threshold power value to obtain a comparison result; and generating a slip status output indicative of whether the slip clutch is slipping based on the comparison result.

2. The computer implemented method of claim 1 wherein obtaining an input frequency comprises: sensing a speed of rotation of the drive shaft; and computing the input frequency based on the sensed speed of rotation of the drive shaft.
3. The computer implemented method of claim 2 wherein obtaining an input frequency comprises: obtaining a slip clutch configuration indicative of a configuration of the slip clutch; and computing the input frequency based on the configuration of the slip clutch.
4. The computer implemented method of claim 3 wherein obtaining a slip clutch configuration comprises: obtaining a physical configuration of the slip clutch, the physical configuration determining a rate at which vibrations are induced on the frame when the slip clutch is slipping, given a frequency of rotation of the drive shaft.
5. The computer implemented method of claim 3 wherein the drive shaft.
6. The computer implemented method of claim 1 wherein obtaining an input frequency comprises: obtaining an expected range of frequencies of rotation of the drive shaft; and computing a set of input frequencies based on the expected range of frequencies of rotation of the drive shaft.
7. The computer implemented method of claim 6 wherein comparing a power of the frequency domain signal to a threshold power value to obtain a comparison result comprises: comparing a power of the frequency domain signal, within a range of the set of input frequencies, to a threshold power value to obtain the comparison result.
8. The computer implemented method of claim 1 and further comprising: determining validity of the slip status output based on a validity criterion; and generating a control signal based on the validity of the slip status output.
9. The computer implemented method of claim 8 wherein determining validity of the slip status output comprises: detecting a characteristic of engagement of the drive shaft; and determining the validity of the slip status output based on the characteristic of engagement of the drive shaft.
10. The computer implemented method of claim 8 wherein generating a control signal comprises: generating the control signal to control an operator interface based on the slip status output.
11. The computer implemented method of claim 8 wherein generating a control signal comprises: generating the control signal to control header functionality or harvester functionality based on the slip status output.
12. The computer implemented method of claim 1 and further comprising: identifying the slip clutch that is slipping based on the power of the frequency domain signal.
13. An agricultural system, comprising: an agricultural harvester; a header coupled to the agricultural harvester, the header having a frame, a drive shaft, a plurality of row units, and a plurality of slip clutches, the drive shaft being configured to transmit power to each row unit, of the plurality of row units, through a separate slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches; a vibration sensor mounted on the frame of the header, configured to generate a sensor signal indicative of sensed vibrations; a signal processing system configured to convert the sensor signal to a digital signal, bandpass filter the digital signal to obtain a filtered signal, demodulate the filtered signal to obtain a demodulated signal, and transform the demodulated signal to a frequency domain signal; an input frequency calculation processor configured to obtain an input frequency indicative of a frequency at which vibrations occur on the frame of the header when a slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, is slipping; a threshold comparison processor configured to compare a power of the frequency domain signal, within a range of the input frequency, to a threshold power value to obtain a comparison result; and a slip status output system configured to generate a slip status output indicative of whether the slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, is slipping based on the comparison result.
14. The agricultural system of claim 13 wherein the input frequency calculation processor is configured to automatically adjust the input frequency by determining whether a frequency of rotation of the drive shaft is sensed, and wherein the threshold comparison processor is configured to automatically adjust the threshold power value based on whether the frequency of rotation of the

drive shaft is sensed.

15. The agricultural system of claim 13 and further comprising: a drive shaft speed sensor configured to sense a speed of rotation of the drive shaft, the input frequency calculation processor being configured to compute the input frequency based on the sensed speed of rotation of the drive shaft.

16. The agricultural system of claim 15 wherein the input frequency calculation processor is configured to obtain a slip clutch configuration indicator indicative of a configuration of the slip clutch and compute the input frequency based on the configuration of the slip clutch.

17. The agricultural system of claim 16 wherein the slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, has a physical configuration that determines a rate at which vibrations are produced on the frame when the slip clutch is slipping, given a frequency of rotation of the drive shaft, and wherein the input frequency calculation processor is configured to compute the input frequency based on the physical configuration of the slip clutch.

18. The agricultural system of claim 16 and further comprising: a gear assembly, having a gear ratio, coupled to transmit power from the drive shaft to the row unit, the input frequency calculation processor being configured to compute the input frequency based on the gear ratio of the gear assembly.

19. The agricultural system of claim 13 and further comprising: an interlock processor configured to determine a validity of the slip status output based on a validity criterion; and a control signal generator configured to generate a control signal based on the validity of the slip status output.

20. An agricultural system, comprising: an agricultural harvester; a header coupled to the agricultural harvester, the header having a frame, a drive shaft, a plurality of row units, and a plurality of slip clutches, the drive shaft being configured to transmit power to each row unit, of the plurality of row units, through a separate slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches; a vibration sensor mounted on the frame of the header, configured to generate a sensor signal indicative of sensed vibrations; a signal processing system configured to convert the sensor signal to a digital signal, bandpass filter the digital signal to obtain a filtered signal, demodulate the filtered signal to obtain a demodulated signal, and transform the demodulated signal to a frequency domain signal; a slip detection system configured to generate a slip status output indicative of whether the slip clutch, of the plurality of slip clutches, is slipping based on the frequency domain signal.
